

provided in Chapter Four; even if not all of the game mechanics make sense right away, having at least a rough idea of what each power is about can make the decision much easier and avoid confusion about what you can and cannot do.

If Arts determine what kind of magic your character can do, then *Realms* determine how you use it. More *Realms* give you more flexibility in how you can use your Arts, by giving you a broader range of possible targets for your powers. You have five points to allocate to *Realms*. As with Arts, while a quick list is provided, it is recommended that you take a look at p. 232 to see what each *Realm* does in more detail.

Step Four: Tempers

Three important Traits make up the *Tempers* category: Willpower, Glamour, and Banality. These represent three fundamental aspects of your character's relationship between the Dreaming and the Autumn world, and interact with the rules a bit differently than the Traits in the first three categories. All changelings start with the same base rating in these traits, modified slightly by your choice of seeming. There are no points to spend here, you simply need to record the ratings as determined by your seeming and any associated choices.

Willpower

This Trait measures your character's self-control as well as her overall drive to carry on despite hardship and setbacks. Willpower may be required to activate certain special powers, as well as to retain self-control in the face of temptation or provocation. It can also provide an extra boost to an especially important roll, representing a character giving her utmost to succeed.

You begin with a Willpower rating of 4. Your character's permanent Willpower rating cannot exceed 10. See p. 258 for more on how Willpower works.

Glamour

Your character's Glamour trait measures the overall strength of her Kithain nature as well as her raw magical potential. Glamour is most often spent to power cantrips, enchant mortals, activate Treasures, or use certain Birthrights and house Boons. It is refreshed through a variety of means, whether gathered from mortals, soaked up in the presence of a freehold's balefire, or acquired through physical tokens of solidified magical energy known as dross. While largely a positive Trait, exposure to high levels of Glamour without some corresponding grounding in Banality can lead to a dangerous condition known as Bedlam.

You begin with a Glamour rating of 4. Your character's permanent Glamour rating cannot exceed 10. See p. 259 for more on Glamour.

Banality

The Banality Trait measures how much the Autumn world has weighed down a character's fae soul, and represents both the accumulated damage a character has suffered at the hands of humanity's disbelief as well as her own inner doubts and fears. Though changelings rightly fear Banality as the harbinger of their undoing, it can also be employed as a last-ditch measure to help defend against cantrips or avoid detection, albeit at a cost.

You begin with a Banality rating of 3. If your character's permanent Banality rating ever reaches 10, she is Undone, and effectively ceases to be a changeling. See p. 267 for more on Banality as a Trait.

Step Five: Birthrights and Frailties

Every kith has unique benefits, known as *Birthrights*, as well as inherited drawbacks, known as *Frailties*. You should look over these Traits carefully, as they often add new systems to your character, or change existing Trait values. For instance, sidhe characters receive a bonus to their Appearance Trait to reflect their otherworldly beauty, while boggans cannot botch any rolls involving the Crafts ability. Bonuses gained from Birthrights may take your character over five dots, granting truly superhuman levels of that Trait.

Step Six: Freebie Points

At this stage you probably have a pretty good idea of who your character is, but it's also likely that you didn't have quite as many points as you wanted in a few categories. That's where freebie points come in! These are points you can spend to purchase new dots or raise existing Traits. Freebie points do not have the same value as the points you were spending before, however; the accompanying chart shows the freebie point cost of different Traits. Remember to consult the Storyteller to discuss if any Traits are restricted or prohibited for the chronicle.

While useful, freebie points do have limits. You cannot raise any Trait above five dots, increase Glamour or Willpower above 10, or raise your Banality rating. The only exception to the five-dot maximum is if a Trait receives a bonus as the result of a

Freebie Point Costs

Traits	Cost
Abilities	2 points per dot
Arts	5 points per dot
Attributes	5 points per dot
Backgrounds	1 point per dot
Glamour	3 points per dot
Merits	Merit rating in points
Realms	2 points per dot
Willpower	2 points per dot